

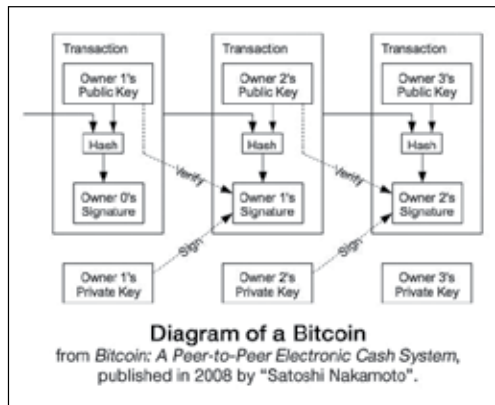
won't be created irrespective of mining efforts. The total number of Bitcoins that can ever be in existence are just less than 21 million at around 20,999,839.77085749 when using the determined 8 decimal point.

The system is designed to reveal blocks every 10 minutes with the initial value of 50 Bitcoins per block. Along with the runtime reduction in Bitcoin payoff, another aspect of the system is that it adaptively changes the difficulty of the mining process based on the rate at which processing power is dedicated to the task. This adaptive reiteration takes place every 2016 blocks based on the time taken to solve that many blocks.

At the current time (January 2014) there are 12274575 BTC in existence with a steady rate of increase. The number of Bitcoins in existence can be easily checked at [<http://blockexplorer.com/q/totalbc>]. And as the network runtime increases the number of Bitcoins mined will half to 12.5 after the next 210,000 blocks and then 6.25 and so on. Due to this iterative division Bitcoins are divisible down to 8 decimal places. Similar to analogue currency, Bitcoins are also used in smaller denominations. The smallest denomination is .00000001 BTC but can be even lower if the existing protocol is augmented.

Similar to paise or cents, Bitcoins are used in fractions of centiBitcoin (bitcent = .01 BTC), milliBitcoin

(mbit = .001 BTC) and microBitcoin (ubit = .000001 BTC). Due to the international nature of the digital currency, Bitcoin denominations are named within the metric SI system rather than imperial or colloquial units such as cents, pence or pound. The only exception is the honorific given to the smallest unit i.e. .00000001 BTC which is called a satoshi. It is named after the pseudonymous creator of the Bitcoin protocol Satoshi Nakamoto.



Most people can't even balance their check books but are expected to understand and accept the mathematics behind Bitcoin!